



Introduction to PHP 30m

PHP is an acronym for PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor. PHP is an open-source, server-side scripting language and a powerful tool for making dynamic and interactive web pages. It is widely used to develop web applications and is one of the main languages used by web developers to make new web applications.

PHP is used by Facebook, Wikipedia and WordPress.

- Facebook was developed primarily using PHP. Facebook has utilised PHP's capability to generate dynamic content in seconds. At its conception, the entire core Facebook application was written in PHP.
- Wikipedia is the most visited public information site. Wikipedia uses PHP along with MySQL and MariaDB as its database.
- WordPress is a CMS that is built using PHP. Other CMSs such as Drupal, Joomla and Magento are also built in PHP.

Watch *Introduction to PHP* (Simplilearn, 2021) (11:26), to learn the basics of PHP. This video will explain why you should use PHP, how PHP works and companies that use PHP.



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Advantages and disadvantages of PHP

PHP has several advantages, which have made it very popular.

Advantage	Description
Cross-platform	PHP is platform-independent as it runs on every platform. It can run on Android, Mac, Windows or Linux.
Open-source	PHP is open-source and a mature language. The original code is made available to the community of developers to use.
Easy to learn	PHP is a language that is easy to learn because it is simple and straightforward to use. It is also easy to learn if you already have programming knowledge.

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PHP syncs with all databases	Programmers and developers can easily connect PHP with both relational and non-relational databases, so PHP can connect with almost any database.
Supportive community	PHP has a very supportive online community. There are many resources available on how to use the features of PHP, as well as guides on how to fix problems and troubleshoot.

PHP also has disadvantages, like any web technology. The disadvantages of PHP are listed below.

Disadvantage	Description
Security	Due to its open-source nature, its source code is freely available to anyone, making it insecure.
Not suitable for all web applications	PHP is not suitable for large content-based web applications. Meta had to create a faster variation of PHP called Hack to overcome this limitation.
PHP knowledge	Developers need to learn to use PHP's built-in functionalities so they can avoid writing additional code.
Lack of debugging tools	It is widely believed by developers that PHP features a poor quality of handling errors because of the lack of debugging tools, which makes it difficult to look for errors and warnings. Compared to other programming languages, PHP has a smaller number of debugging tools available.



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